



# Chart elements

ON SOCIAL MEDIA

ON WEB PUBLICATIONS

ON PUBLICATIONS

TABLES

MAPS



1 Title maximum 2 lines

---

Helvetica Neue LT Std 75 Bold  
#231f20  
26 px  
Leading 30 px  
10 px space between the title and arrow

## 2 Subtitle maximum 2 lines

Helvetica Neue LT Std 65 Medium  
#231F20  
19 px  
Leading 22 px

### 3 Source / note

---

Helvetica Neue LT Std 46 Light Italic  
#231F20  
15 px  
Leading 17 px

Helvetica Neue LT Std 45 Light  
#231F20  
15 px  
Leading 17 px  
Space before Note 2 px

**Width 500 x height 500 px**

Width 500 px = 100%

**Dimensions and spacing vary only if the width changes.**

So everything increases or decreases proportionally

- 40 px = 8%
- 20 px = 4%
- 15 px = 3%
- 10 px = 2%
- 6 px = 1.2%

Chart:

Legend **4**

Helvetica Neue  
LT Std 47 Light Condensed  
#6E6259  
19 px  
Leading 21 px

X and Y axis label 5

Helvetica Neue  
LT Std 47 Light Condensed  
#6E625  
17 px

Annotations **6**

Helvetica Neue  
LT Std 47 Light Condensed  
#6E6259  
19 px  
Leading 22 px

Data label **7**

Helvetica Neue  
LT Std 47 Light Condensed  
#231F20 or #FFFFFF  
19 px  
Leading 22 px

## Lines

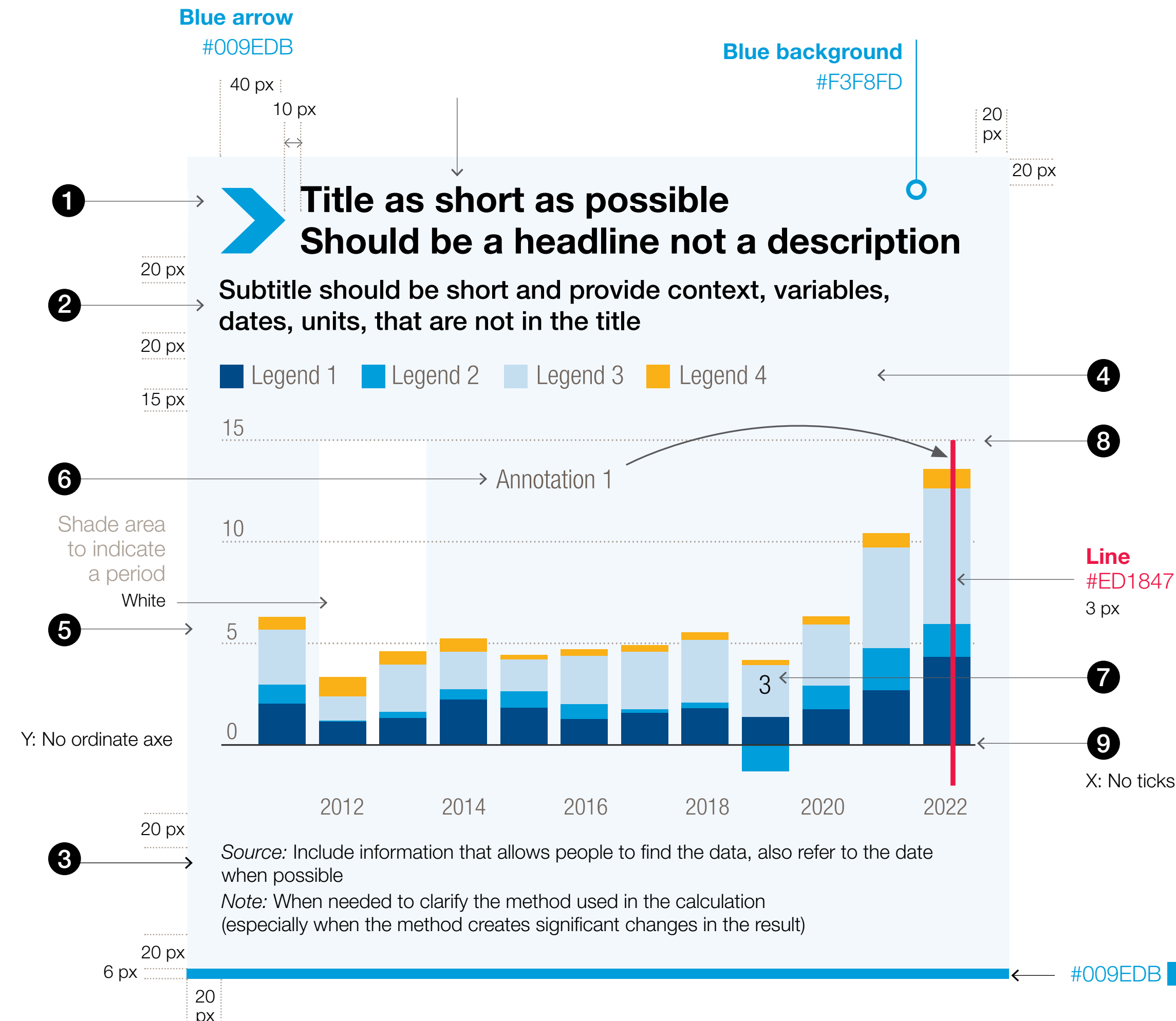
..... 1 px #AAA096  
Dash 1 px | Gap 2 px

— 1 px #231F20

**HIGHLIGHT A MESSAGE**

You can highlight an important message with  
**a red box #ED1847**

Helvetica Neue LT Std  
47 Light condensed - White  
19 px - Leading 22 px





# Web publications

## Text:

- 1

Title maximum 2 lines

Helvetica Neue LT Std 75 Bold  
#231f20  
26 px  
Leading 30 px  
10 px space between the title and arrow
- 2

Subtitle maximum 2 lines

Helvetica Neue LT Std 65 Medium  
#231F20  
19 px  
Leading 22 px
- 3

Source / note

Helvetica Neue LT Std 46 Light Italic  
#231F20  
15 px  
Leading 17 px

Text source / note

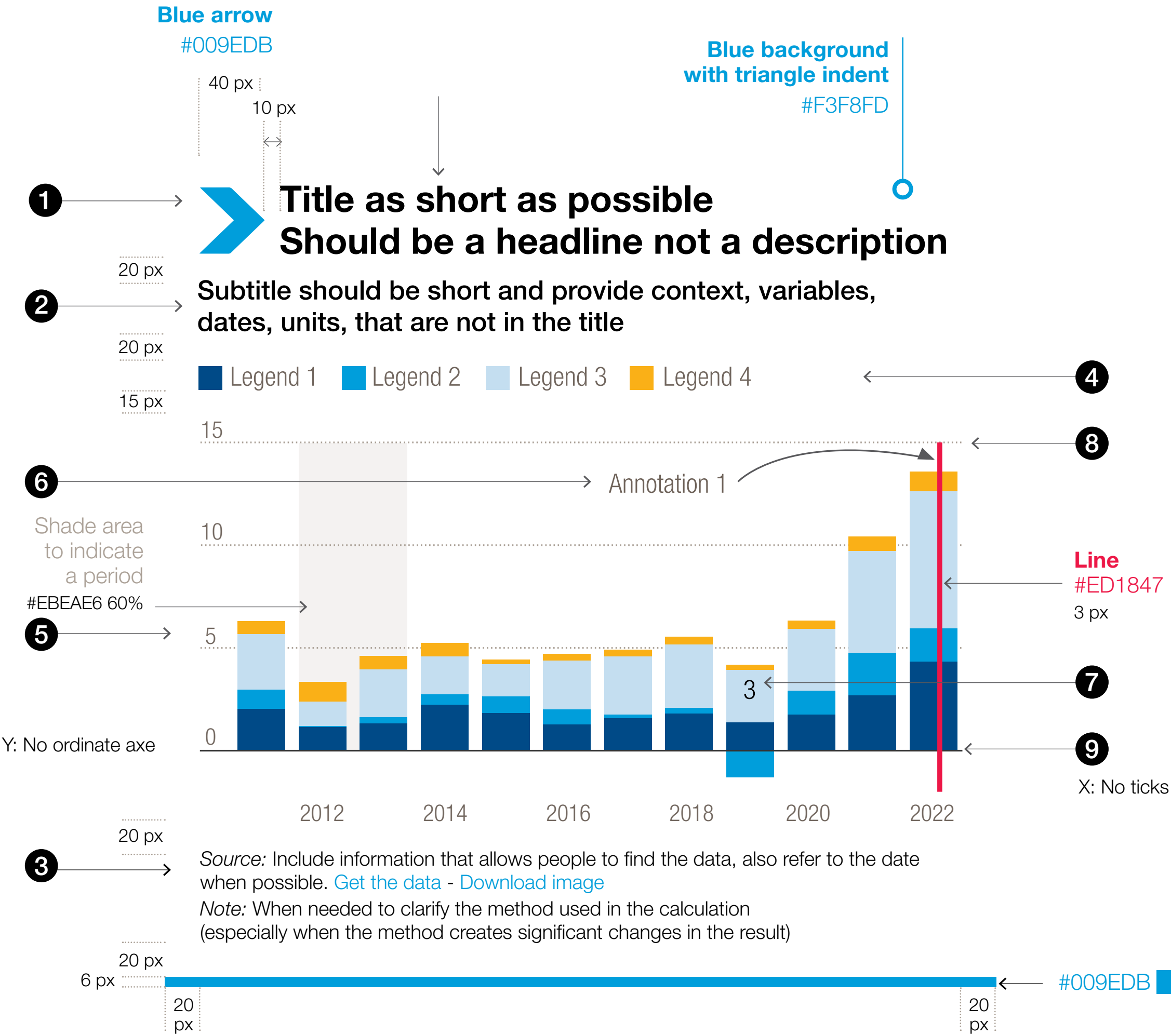
Helvetica Neue LT Std 45 Light  
#231F20  
15 px  
Leading 17 px  
Space before Note 2 px

Width 500 x height 500 px

Width 500 px = 100%

Dimensions and spacing vary only if the width changes.  
So everything increases or decreases proportionally

40 px = 8%  
20 px = 4%  
15 px = 3%  
10 px = 2%  
6 px = 1.2%



## Chart:

- 4

Legend

Helvetica Neue  
LT Std 47 Light Condensed  
#6E6259  
19 px  
Leading 21 px
- 5

X and Y axis label

Helvetica Neue  
LT Std 47 Light Condensed  
#6E625  
17 px
- 6

Annotations

Helvetica Neue  
LT Std 47 Light Condensed  
#6E6259  
19 px  
Leading 22 px
- 7

Data label

Helvetica Neue  
LT Std 47 Light Condensed  
#231F20 or #FFFFFF  
19 px  
Leading 22 px
- 8

Lines

..... 1 px #AAA096  
Dash 1 px | Gap 2 px

—— 1 px #231F20
- 9

HIGHLIGHT A MESSAGE

You can highlight an important message with a red box #ED1847

Helvetica Neue LT Std 47 Light condensed - White  
19 px - Leading 22 px





# Publications

## Text:

### 1 Figure

Helvetica Neue LT Std 75 Bold  
C80 M20 Y0 B0  
11 pts  
Leading 12 pts

#### Title

Helvetica Neue LT Std 75 Bold  
Black 80%  
11 pts  
Leading 12 pts

#### Subtitle

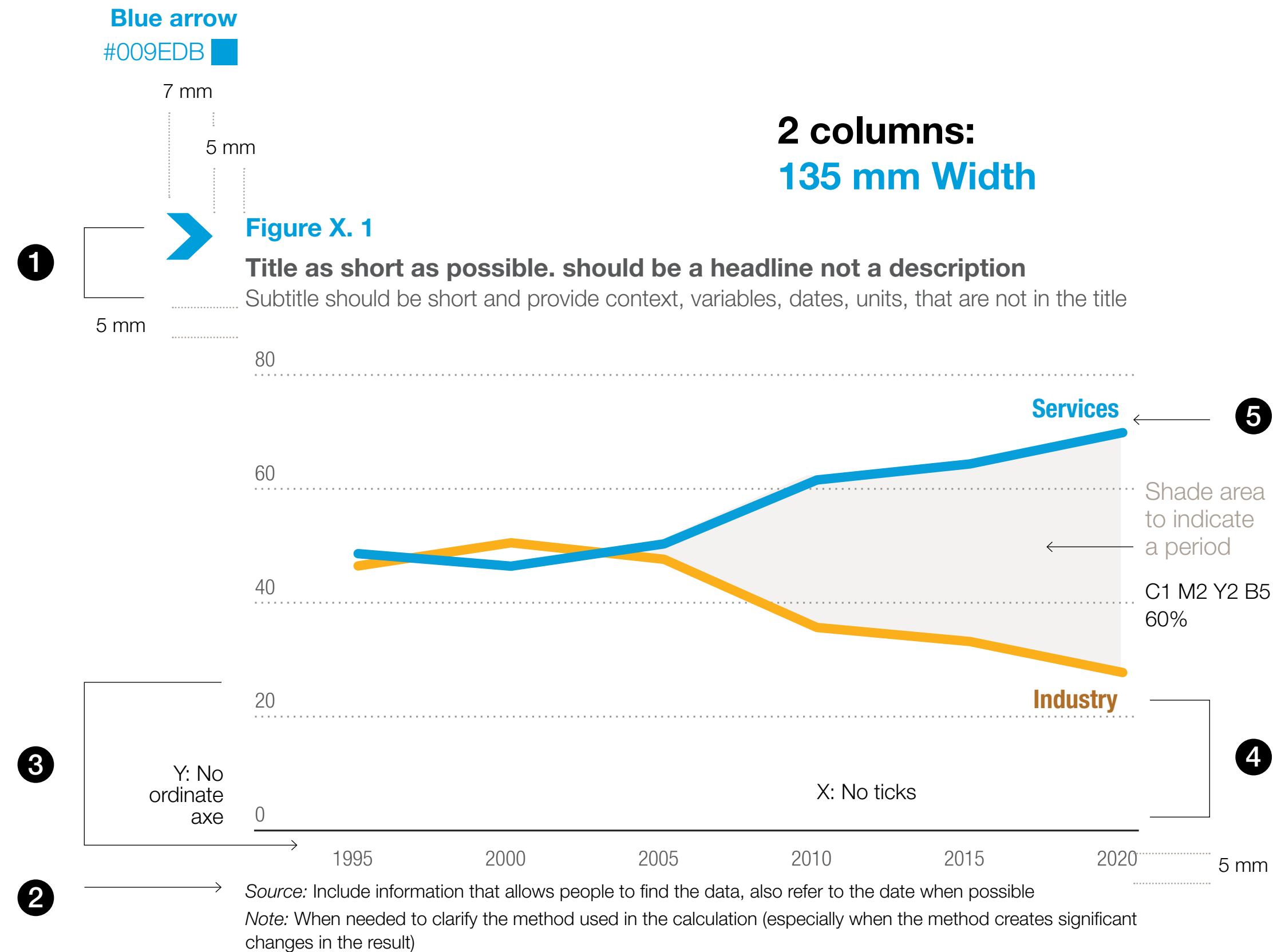
Helvetica Neue LT Std 45 Light  
Black  
10 pts  
Leading 13 pts

### 2 Source / note

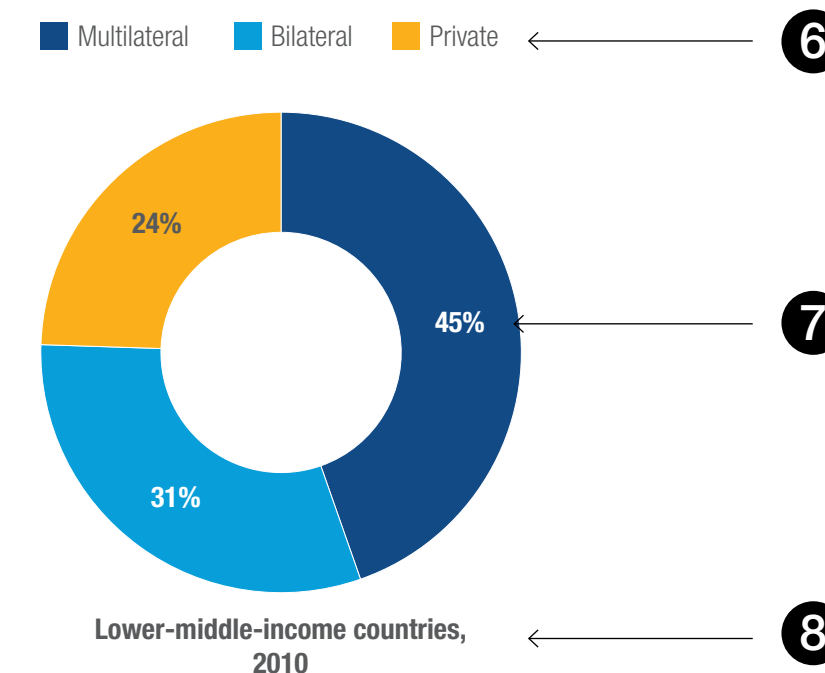
Helvetica Neue LT Std 46 Light Italic  
Black  
8 pts  
Leading 10 pts

#### Text source / note

Helvetica Neue LT Std 45 Light  
Black  
8 pts  
Leading 10 pts



### 1 column: 64.5 mm Width



#### HIGHLIGHT A MESSAGE

You can highlight an important message with a red box #ED1847

Helvetica Neue LT Std 65 Medium  
White  
10 pts  
Leading 12 pts

## Chart:

### X and Y axis label

Helvetica Neue LT Std 47 Light Condensed  
Black 80%  
8.5 pts

### Lines

0.75 pt 50% Back  
Dash 0.75 pt | Gap 2 pts

### Lines

1 pt Black  
4 pts

### Legend

Helvetica Neue LT Std 47 Light Condensed  
Black 80%  
9 pts  
Leading 10 pts

### Data label

Helvetica Neue LT Std 47 bold Condensed  
80% Back or White  
11 pts  
Leading 13 pts

### Annotations

Helvetica Neue LT Std 47 bold Condensed  
11 pts  
Leading 13 pts



# Tables

Text:

- 1

Table

Helvetica Neue LT Std 75 Bold  
C80 M20 Y0 B0  
11 pts  
Leading 12 pts

Title

Helvetica Neue LT Std 75 Bold  
Black 80%  
11 pts  
Leading 12 pts

Subtitle

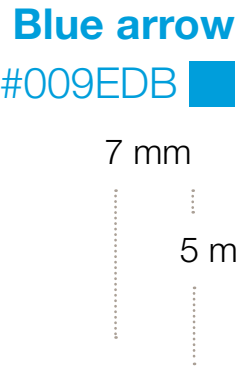
Helvetica Neue LT Std 45 Light  
Black  
10 pts  
Leading 13 pts
- 2

Source / note

Helvetica Neue LT Std 46 Light Italic  
Black  
8 pts  
Leading 10 pts

Text source / note

Helvetica Neue LT Std 45 Light  
Black  
8 pts  
Leading 10 pts



2 columns: 135 mm width or  
3 columns: 160 mm width

1

Table X. 1

Title as short as possible. should be a headline not a description

Subtitle should be short and provide context, dates, units, that are not in the title

|              | Importing countries/regions           |                     |                                     |      | Exporting countries/regions         |                     |                                     |      |
|--------------|---------------------------------------|---------------------|-------------------------------------|------|-------------------------------------|---------------------|-------------------------------------|------|
|              | Top importers 2022                    | Percentage share(1) | Top percentage changes 2021-2022    |      | Top exporters 2022                  | Percentage share(1) | Top percentage changes 2021-2022    |      |
| Crude oil    | 1 Total Asia                          | 58.1                | Latin America and the Caribbean     | 22.2 | Middle East/Gulf                    | 47.4                | North America                       | 21.5 |
|              | 2 Total Europe                        | 25.9                | India                               | 10.4 | Latin America and the Caribbean     | 10.0                | Black Sea                           | 14.9 |
|              | 3 China                               | 22.8                | Baltic                              | 10.2 | North America                       | 9.7                 | Middle East/Gulf                    | 14.6 |
|              | 4 India                               | 11.7                | United Kingdom / Continental Europe | 10.1 | West Africa                         | 8.2                 | Baltic                              | 5.5  |
|              | 5 United Kingdom / Continental Europe | 11.5                | Other Asia                          | 10.0 | Mediterranean                       | 6.1                 | Latin America and the Caribbean     | 3.7  |
| Oil products | 1 Total Asia                          | 31.4                | Middle East/Gulf                    | 21.7 | Total Europe                        | 34.1                | Latin America                       | 24.1 |
|              | 2 Total Americas                      | 20.1                | Latin America                       | 14.0 | Middle East/Gulf                    | 18.4                | Total Americas                      | 12.8 |
|              | 3 South East Asia                     | 16.9                | Indian Subcontinent                 | 11.9 | Total Americas                      | 16.0                | United States                       | 11.3 |
|              | 4 United Kingdom/ Continental Europe  | 16.9                | Africa (inc. Mediterranean)         | 8.3  | United Kingdom/ Continental Europe  | 14.4                | East Asia (inc. Russian Federation) | 9.8  |
|              | 5 Latin America                       | 11.6                | United Kingdom / Continental Europe | 2.3  | East Asia (inc. Russian Federation) | 13.9                | Middle East/Gulf                    | 9.0  |
| Coal         | 1 Total Asia                          | 82.2                | European Union + United Kingdom     | 34.4 | Indonesia                           | 38.2                | Canada                              | 12.9 |
|              | 2 India                               | 19.8                | India                               | 19.1 | Australia                           | 27.6                | South Africa                        | 9.2  |
|              | 3 China                               | 19.0                | Japan                               | 1.1  | Russian Federation                  | 12.9                | Indonesia                           | 7.8  |
|              | 4 European Union + United Kingdom     | 9.8                 | Republic of Korea                   | 0.8  | Total North America                 | 8.7                 | North America                       | 2.9  |
|              | 5 Republic of Korea                   | 9.8                 |                                     |      | United States                       | 5.9                 |                                     |      |

2

Source: Include information that allows people to find the data, also refer to the date when possible

Note: When needed to clarify the method used in the calculation (especially when the method creates significant changes in the result)

Table:

- X Lines

3

No lines
- Y Lines

4

0.75 pt Black
- Last line

2 pts Blue
- Titles

5

Helvetica Neue  
LT Std bold Condensed  
Black or Blue  
11 pts  
Leading 13 pts
- Subtitles

6

Helvetica Neue  
LT Std Condensed  
Black or Blue  
11 pts  
Leading 13 pts
- Data

7

Helvetica Neue  
LT Std Light Condensed  
Black  
11 pts  
Leading 13 pts
- Column or rows highlights

8

C0 M2 Y30 B0





# Maps

Our **Statistics Service** is responsible for providing colleagues with up-to-date UN official maps and maintains a dedicated page on the UNCTAD intranet for this purpose. UNCTAD maps adhere to the UN's "Administrative Instruction on Guidelines for the Publication of Maps". The UN Geospatial Information Section is responsible for clearing maps.

**Maritza Ascencios** provides policy guidance on official country/territory names, geographic locations and the inclusion of relevant disclaimers, depending on the specific map or data.

Further information will be forthcoming via [Insider](#), the UNCTAD intranet portal.

Should you have any questions regarding maps, please contact:  
[statistics@unctad.org](mailto:statistics@unctad.org) copying  
[maritza.ascencios@un.org](mailto:maritza.ascencios@un.org)





# Colour palette

This data visualization colour palette is an extended version of the UNCTAD colour palette. It is developed specifically for visualizing data in infographics, maps or charts.

[COLOUR PALETTE](#)[COLOUR RAMP](#)[RECOMMENDATIONS](#)[COLOUR COMBINATIONS](#)



# Colour palette

Blue is the primary colour and should be the predominant colour in all UNCTAD visuals. Try to limit the number of different colours in a single graph.

In some cases, more colours may be used to ensure clarity, such as distinguishing between different categories within the data.

For effective data visualization, how colours are used and paired can significantly influence the interpretation and clarity of the information presented . In this guide you will find recommendations on how to use and pair colours for different types of data:

- ➞ Categorical data
- ➞ Diverging data
- ➞ Sequential data

## Main colours



|         |                  |
|---------|------------------|
| BLUE    | (primary colour) |
| CMYK    | 80, 20, 0, 0     |
| RGB     | 0, 158, 219      |
| HEX     | #009EDB          |
| PANTONE | 2925             |



|         |                 |
|---------|-----------------|
| YELLOW  | (accent colour) |
| CMYK    | 0, 35, 100, 0   |
| RGB     | 252, 175, 23    |
| HEX     | #FBAF17         |
| PANTONE | 7549            |



|           |                |
|-----------|----------------|
| WARM GREY |                |
| CMYK      | 10, 15, 20, 30 |
| RGB       | 170, 160, 150  |
| HEX       | #AEA29A        |
| PANTONE   | Warm Gray 5    |

## Secondary colours



|         |              |
|---------|--------------|
| PURPLE  |              |
| CMYK    | 40, 70, 0, 0 |
| RGB     | 160, 95, 180 |
| HEX     | #A05FB4      |
| PANTONE | 2583         |



|         |               |
|---------|---------------|
| GREEN   |               |
| CMYK    | 60, 0, 100, 0 |
| RGB     | 114, 191, 68  |
| HEX     | #72BF44       |
| PANTONE | 368           |



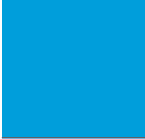
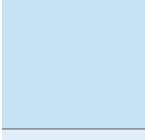
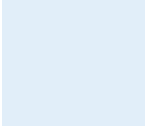
|         |               |
|---------|---------------|
| RED     |               |
| CMYK    | 0, 100, 70, 0 |
| RGB     | 237, 24, 71   |
| HEX     | #ED1847       |
| PANTONE | 192           |

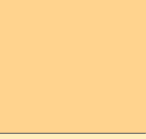


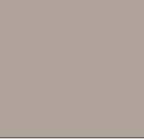
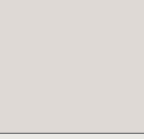
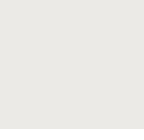


# Colour ramp

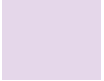
## Main colours

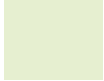
| BLUE                                                                                | CMYK           | RGB           | HEX     | PANTONE    |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------|---------------|---------|------------|
|    | 100, 70, 0, 10 | 0, 73, 135    | #004987 | 301        |
|    | 87, 74, 0, 0   | 0, 119, 184   | #0077B8 | 7461       |
|    | 80, 20, 0, 0   | 0, 158, 219   | #009EDB | 2925       |
|    | 48, 15, 0, 0   | 123, 183, 225 | #7BB7E1 | 2175       |
|   | 20, 4, 0, 0    | 197, 223, 239 | #C5DFEF | 290        |
|  | 10, 0, 0, 0    | 227, 237, 246 | #E3EDF6 | 50% P. 290 |

| YELLOW                                                                               | CMYK            | RGB           | HEX     | PANTONE     |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|---------------|---------|-------------|
|   | 25, 60, 100, 10 | 176, 110, 42  | #B06E2A | 7511        |
|   | 15, 60, 100, 0  | 215, 125, 42  | #D67C29 | 7565        |
|   | 0, 35, 100, 0   | 252, 175, 23  | #FBAF17 | 7549        |
|   | 0, 18, 50, 0    | 255, 212, 142 | #FFD48E | 1345        |
|  | 0, 5, 30, 0     | 255, 244, 191 | #FFF4BF | 50% P. 1345 |

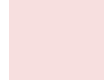
| WARM GREY                                                                            | CMYK           | RGB           | HEX     | PANTONE         |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------|---------------|---------|-----------------|
|   | 53, 53, 58, 50 | 79, 71, 65    | #4F4740 | 7771            |
|   | 25, 30, 35, 50 | 110, 98, 89   | #6E6259 | Warm Gray 11    |
|   | 10, 15, 20, 30 | 170, 160, 150 | #AEA29A | Warm Gray 5     |
|   | 3, 4, 5, 10    | 222, 217, 213 | #DED9D5 | Warm Gray 1     |
|  | 1, 2, 2, 5     | 235, 234, 230 | #EBEAE6 | 50% Warm Gray 1 |

## Secondary colours

| PURPLE                                                                              | CMYK           | RGB           | HEX     | PANTONE     |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------|---------------|---------|-------------|
|  | 90, 100, 0, 25 | 56, 31, 117   | #381F75 | 2685        |
|  | 80, 100, 0, 5  | 91, 44, 134   | #5B2C86 | 2597        |
|  | 40, 70, 0, 0   | 160, 95, 180  | #A05FB4 | 2583        |
|  | 15, 30, 0, 0   | 213, 180, 214 | #D5B4D6 | 2563        |
|  | 8, 15, 0, 0    | 228, 215, 232 | #E4D7E8 | 50% P. 2563 |

| GREEN                                                                                 | CMYK             | RGB           | HEX     | PANTONE    |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------|---------------|---------|------------|
|  | 100, 35, 100, 39 | 0, 87, 46     | #00562E | 342        |
|  | 90, 35, 80, 20   | 0, 103, 71    | #006747 | 7728       |
|  | 60, 0, 100, 0    | 114, 191, 168 | #72BF44 | 368        |
|  | 20, 0, 50, 0     | 206, 227, 160 | #CEE3A0 | 365        |
|  | 10, 0, 20, 0     | 230, 239, 208 | #E6EFD0 | 50% P. 365 |

OR

| RED                                                                                   | CMYK             | RGB           | HEX     | PANTONE    |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------|---------------|---------|------------|
|  | 37, 100, 100, 31 | 127, 27, 29   | #7E1A1C | 1815       |
|  | 25, 100, 80, 15  | 167, 31, 54   | #A71F36 | 201        |
|  | 0, 100, 70, 0    | 237, 24, 71   | #ED1847 | 192        |
|  | 0, 30, 10, 0     | 249, 192, 197 | #F9C0C5 | 176        |
|  | 0, 15, 5, 0      | 247, 223, 223 | #F7DFDF | 50% P. 176 |



# General recommendations

## Colour pairing | Colour ramps



When crafting visual content, it's crucial to ensure it's accessible to people with colour vision defects. Mixing green and red might be problematic for them. If you must use both colours, ensure there's a strong contrast in brightness, like combining a light green with a dark red, to make them more distinguishable.



For mapping and spatial data, reserve the lightest hues – such as the palest blues or greens – for background elements or less critical information, as these shades offer subtle differentiation without overwhelming the visual.



Yellow, when set against a white backdrop, lacks contrast, making it hard to see. A more effective approach is to pair yellow with a darker colour, like blue, ensuring the data stands out clearly.



In visualizations depicting data with positive and negative outcomes, adopting blue for positive results and red for negative ones can convey the message clearly. However, for representations involving gender, it's prudent to steer clear of the traditional blue-red dichotomy. A combination like blue and navy offers a more neutral and inclusive alternative.



Highlighting specific data points within a chart or graph requires thoughtful colour selection. For emphasis within a chart predominantly in blue tones, yellow can serve as a striking highlight. Conversely, in a grey-toned chart, a splash of blue can draw the eye effectively.

These guidelines not only ensure your visuals are accessible and clear to a wider audience but also enhance the overall effectiveness of your data presentation.

## Different colour values:

Use **CMYK** colours on coated and uncoated paper for offset printing, such as magazines, brochures, leaflets, full colour ads, etc.

Use **RGB** colours for computer presentations, digital displays, TV productions, etc.

Use **HEX** colours online.

Use **Pantone** to ensure precise color matching for printing when your document is in 2 or 3 colors only.



# Colour combination

The colour combination significantly influences the interpretation and clarity of the information presented. Below are recommendations on how to use and pair colours for different types of data, focusing on ensuring that visualizations are both accessible and informative.

## ➞ Categorical Data

**It is not recommended to have more than five groups in one single chart.**

If there are more than five groups, we suggest consolidating the categories or breaking up the chart into two or more.

Categorical variables are those that take on distinct labels without an inherent order. Examples include country, region, activity or gender. Each possible value of the variable is assigned with a contrasting colour from a categorical palette.

## Categorical palette

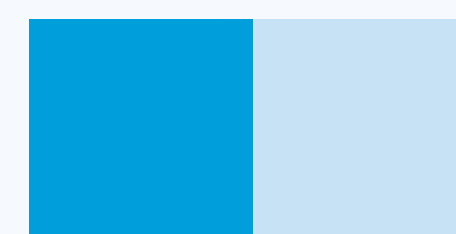
### Distinct Colours

Use clearly distinguishable colours for different categories to help viewers differentiate between groups without confusion.

1 GROUP



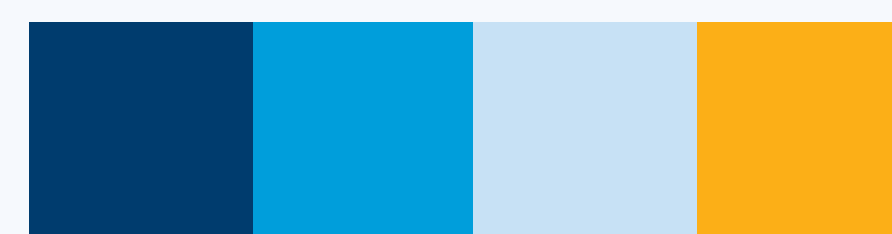
2 GROUPS



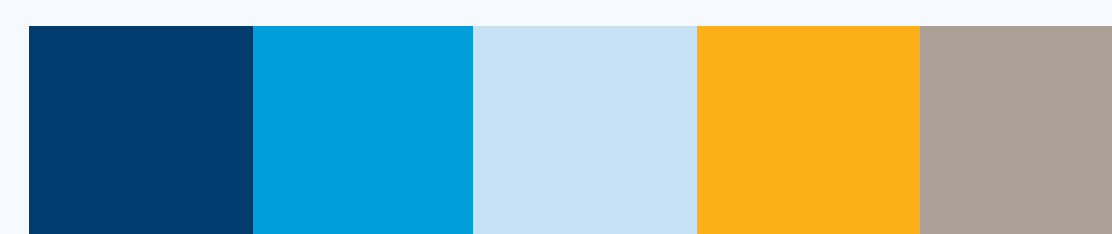
3 GROUPS



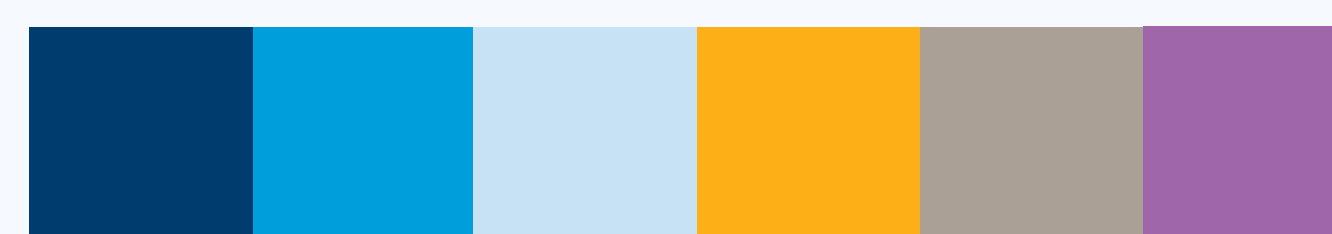
4 GROUPS



5 GROUPS



6 GROUPS



7 GROUPS



OR



➞ Colour code





## Colour combinaison

### ➞ Diverging Data

A diverging palette combines two sequential palettes, where the common endpoint is located in the middle and the shades of each hue progress from lighter to darker towards the extremities. Diverging colours also have numeric meaning.

It's often used to visualize negative and positive values with a baseline in the middle, like economic growth. More shades of colour can be added on both side of the palette as shown when the number of groups increases.

#### Note:

Sequential and diverging palettes can be associated with data values in two different ways:

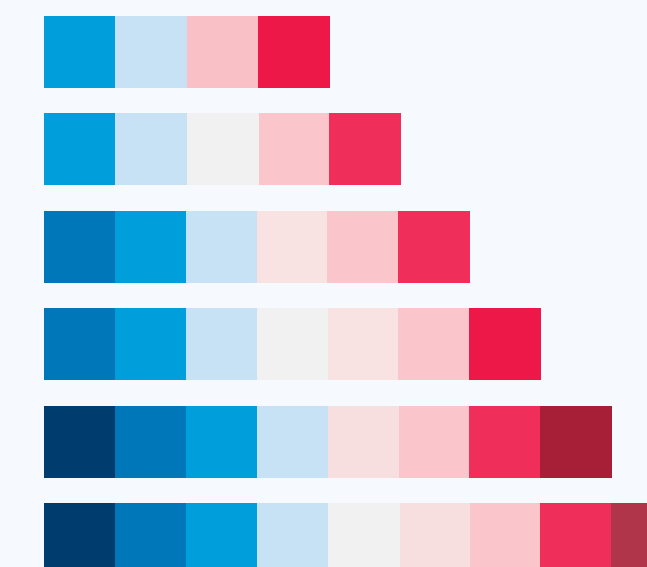
either as a discrete set of colours, each one associated with a numeric range,

or as a continuous function between numeric value and colour.

## Diverging palette

➞ Colour code

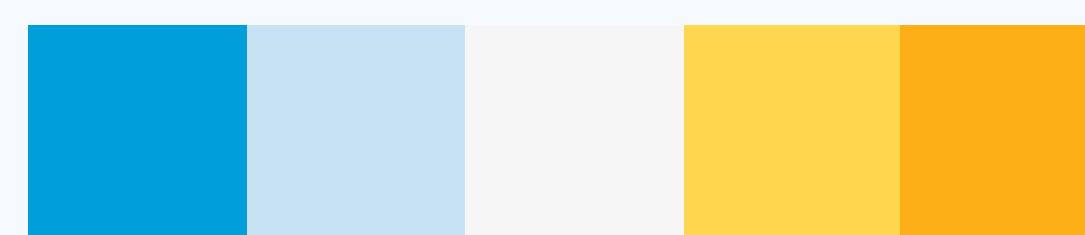
Positive to negative



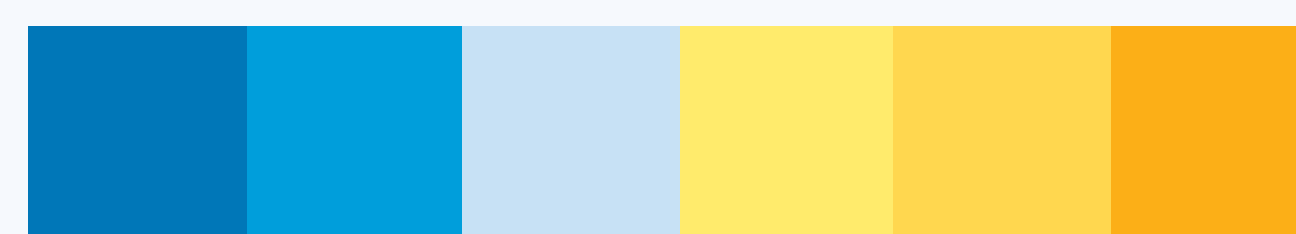
4 GROUPS



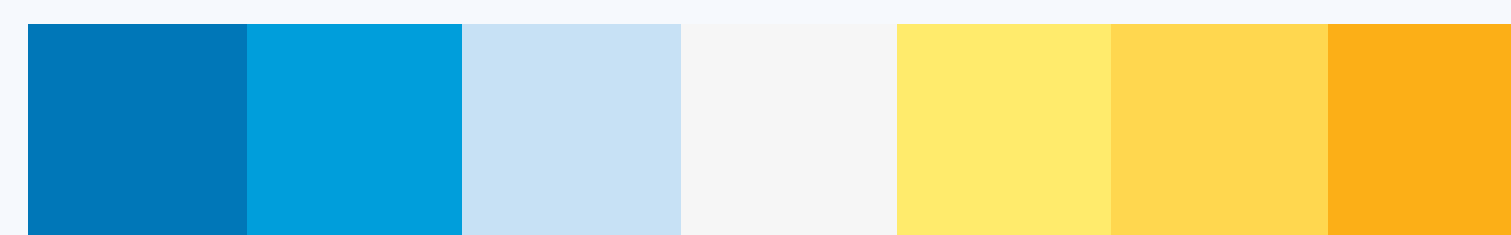
5 GROUPS



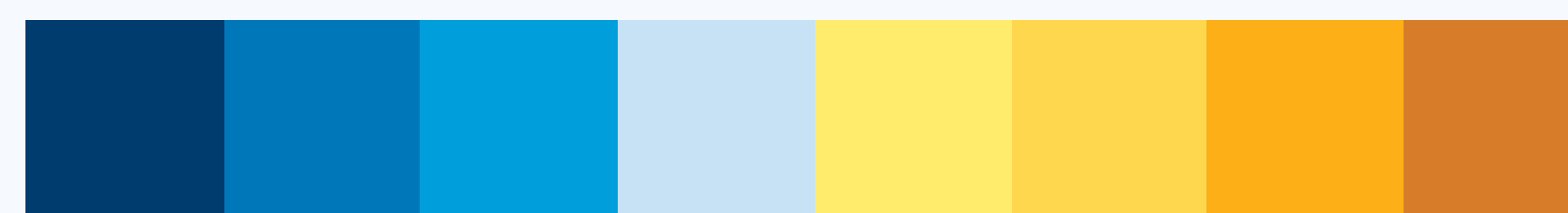
6 GROUPS



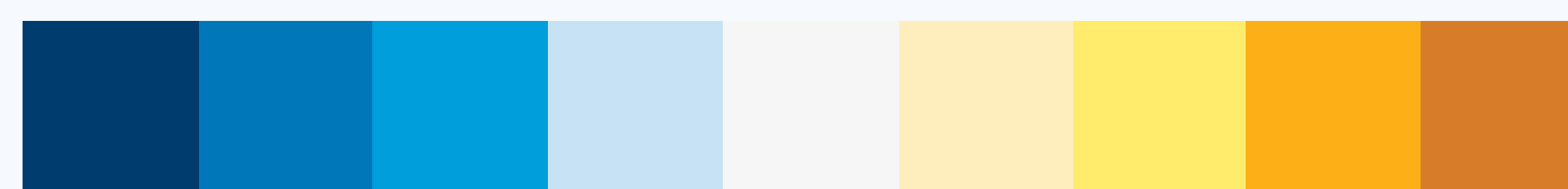
7 GROUPS



8 GROUPS



9 GROUPS



### Two-Hue Approach

For data that diverges from a central midpoint (such as temperature variations from a norm), use two contrasting hues to represent each side of the spectrum. Ensure that the midpoint is clearly marked, often with a neutral colour.

### Symmetry

Balance the colour intensity on both sides of the midpoint to ensure that one side does not visually dominate the other, which could skew interpretation.





## ➞ Sequential Data

A sequential palette is used when the variable is numeric or has inherently ordered values. It is a gradation of colours that go from light to dark or the other way round.

Sequential colours have numeric meanings. They're great for visualizing numbers that go from low to high, like population, income, temperature or age.

More shades of colour can be added as shown when the number of groups increases.

## Sequential palette

➞ Colour code

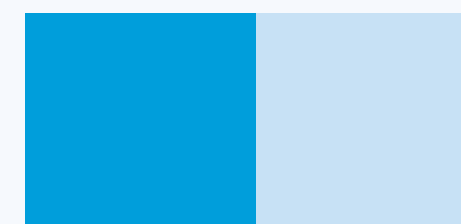
### Gradient Schemes

Utilize colour gradients for sequential data to represent a progression from low to high values. Choose a single hue with a gradual change in brightness or saturation to indicate intensity, quantity or percentage increase.

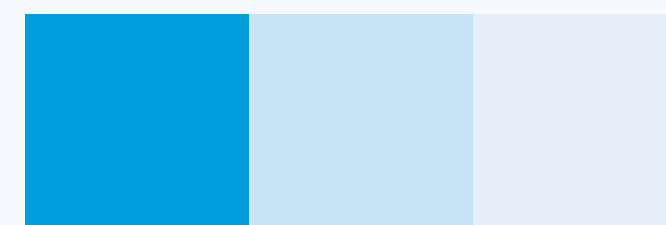
### Consistency

Maintain consistency in the direction of the gradient across different visualizations to avoid confusion (e.g., dark to light colours should consistently represent low to high values).

2 GROUPS



3 GROUPS



4 GROUPS



5 GROUPS



6 GROUPS

